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Chapter 2 - J Exchange Visitor Eligibility

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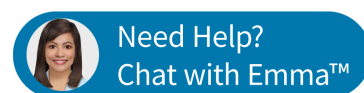
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A. Programs

The J exchange visitor must be entering the United States to take part in a program that has been designated by the U.S. Department of State (DOS) and meets the DOS regulatory requirements stated in [22 CFR 62](#). The designated exchange visitor program categories are:

- Professors and research scholars;
- Short-term scholars;
- Trainees and interns;
- College and university students;
- Teachers;
- Secondary school students;
- Specialists;
- Physicians;
- International visitors;
- Government visitors;
- Camp counselors;



- Au pairs; and
- Summer work travel.^[1]

B. General Criteria

While each program has specific requirements, J-1 exchange visitors are required to:

- Have been accepted in a DOS-approved exchange visitor program before applying for a visa^[2] or applying for a change of status to J-1 while in the United States;
- Have sufficient funds to cover their expenses while in the United States;^[3]
- Have sufficient knowledge of English to be able to participate effectively in the exchange visitor program;^[4] and
- Have a residence abroad which they do not intend to abandon.^[5]

Footnotes

^[^1] See [22 CFR 62, Subpart B](#).

^[^2] See [9 FAM 402.5-6\(C\)](#), Qualifying for an Exchange Visitor Visa (J-1). DOS is responsible for visa processing. See [22 CFR 41.62\(a\)\(1\)](#).

^[^3] Exchange visitors must maintain sufficient medical insurance for accident or illness for themselves and their dependent family members in a minimum amount of \$50,000 per accident or illness. See [22 CFR 62.14](#).

^[^4] See [22 CFR 41.62\(a\)\(3\)](#).

^[^5] See [INA 101\(a\)\(15\)\(J\)](#).

Current as of December 22, 2025
